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Military History Night

organized by James Ellis

HMCS *Canada* Expedition 2025: Rediscovering Canada's First Purpose-Built Warship

with expedition leader and field sciences writer

Joseph Frey CD, FRCGS

1930 Wednesday, September 16

Plated two-course Dinner \$64 inclusive.

Dinner service begins at 1800

(Lecture Free of Charge)

To make reservations, book online at www.rcmi.org or contact Susan Cook at susan.cook@rcmi.org or phone at 416-597-0286 ext 111.

48-hour cancellation policy in effect.



In December 2025, a Canadian-led team of technical divers, marine archaeologists, and imaging specialists conducted the first comprehensive archaeological 3D photogrammetric survey of HMCS *Canada*, Canada's first purpose-built warship and the only ship of its kind ever built. Resting 70 metres (235 feet) beneath the waters of NOAA's Florida Keys National Marine Sanctuary, the vessel served Canada before and during the First World War, survived the Halifax Explosion, served as the Royal Canadian Navy's second flagship, and later sank as the passenger vessel *Queen of Nassau* on July 2, 1926.

Drawing upon newly released expedition findings, expedition leader Joseph Frey will describe the history of the ship, the challenges of deep-water exploration, and the technologies used to create a detailed digital model of the wreck. The presentation will also examine archaeological discoveries, the impact of human activity on the site, and the role the wreck now plays as a thriving marine ecosystem. Through photography, video, and 3D imagery, audiences will gain a rare look at one of Canada's most important yet largely forgotten naval heritage sites.

Joseph Frey, CD, FRCGS is an explorer, expedition leader, science writer, retired Canadian Armed Forces officer, and Vice-President of The Royal Canadian Geographical Society. He participated in the 2014 Victoria Strait Expedition that discovered Sir John Franklin's flagship, HMS *Erebus*, and has taken part in archaeological, scientific, and exploration projects throughout the Arctic, Antarctic, Atlantic, Caribbean, and Pacific regions.

In 2025, he led the HMCS *Canada* Expedition, a Canadian-led scientific and archaeological project that documented Canada's first purpose-built warship through advanced 3D photogrammetry and marine heritage and ecological assessments in collaboration with NOAA's Florida Keys National Marine Sanctuary.

His websites can be visited at

<https://www.hmcsCanadaexpedition.org/>

<https://battleoftheatlanticmemorial.org/>

